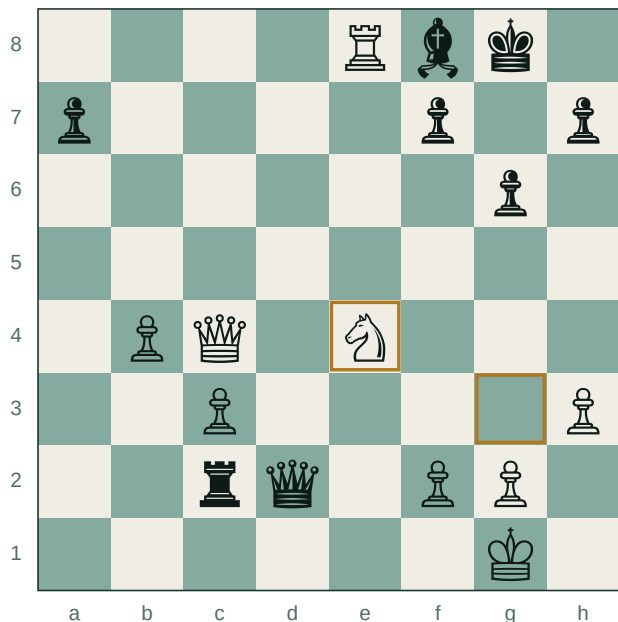


Active defensive resources: Black, move 31

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 31.Ne4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31...Rc1+ 32. Kh2 Qf4+ 33. g3 Qf3 34. Rxf8+ Kxf8 35. Qc5+ Kg8

31...Rc1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **32.Kh2**.

32...Qf4+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From f4 it attacks king on h2 and knight on e4. Recorded reply: **33.g3**.

33...Qf3 The queen moves from f4 to f3. Recorded reply: **34.Rxf8+**.

34...Kxf8 The king captures the rook on f8. Recorded reply: **35.Qc5+**.

35...Kg8 The king moves from f8 to g8.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 18 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +2:** the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on e8 and queen on c4. Check for tactical protection.